

**Acting4U**

**STAGE  
PLAYS  
FOR SCHOOLS**

**ALLEN GILLON**

**CALAMITY JANE**

*Tribute*



**Humorous and entertaining play giving children an opportunity to dress up as goodies and baddies in the wild, wild West. The new school teacher has to be escorted into town by stage coach.**

**Grades 3 - 12**

# **CALAMITY JANE**

## **OVERVIEW**

### **FUN IN THE WILD, WILD WEST!**

When the school teacher quits and leaves town, the folks of Dakota decide to bring in a new one. There's only one track into town and that is through Dakota Pass. The Chief of the Rap-dancin' Tribe seizes on the opportunity to make some easy money. They hold-up the stage coach and capture the new school teacher. Awesome! What happens next? They should have listened to their tribal elders ...

### **INVOLVEMENT**

Projects on "Cultures" may be applicable in your school. Art and craft lessons to create cowboy suits, backdrops, bandanas, feathers, quivers, bows and arrows etc. will involve many students, plus follow up with discussion groups and written essays. Reports from internet forums can crystallise individual thinking on the subject. Building a pretend stage coach with rotating wheels, paper-mache horse heads, hessian horses, alfoil and lots of colours will keep many entertained. Plus, backdrops for the Saloon Bar scene and hills for the stage coach! Rapping lessons and accompanying dance music presents exciting opportunities for Poetry lessons. Whip cracking demonstrations may be possible, depending on location.

### **SONGS from the movie Calamity Jane**

"Black Hills of Dakota"

"Careless With the Truth"

"Secret Love"

"The Deadwood Stage"

"Background rap music for Rap-dancin' Tribe"

Alternative songs appropriate to the generation may be used.

### **LENGTH**

The Play is about 45 mins long. It may be lengthened by adding other songs. An Interval could be inserted between Acts.

# CALAMITY JANE

## *Tribute*

### THE CHARACTERS

In order of appearance –

|                         |                                            |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Barman:                 | - behind the bar wiping up glasses         |
| Hickock:                | - Saloon customer                          |
| 1 <sup>st</sup> Cowboy: | - with big cowboy hat                      |
| 2 <sup>nd</sup> Cowboy: | - with big boots and spurs                 |
| Lieutenant:             | - Army trouser                             |
| Calamity Jane:          | - straight shootin', rough ridin', cowgirl |
| Rattlesnake:            | - Calamity's offsider                      |
| Chief:                  | - 1st Rapper of the Rap-dancin' tribe      |
| White Cloud:            | - 2 <sup>nd</sup> Rapper                   |
| Rain in Face:           | - 3 <sup>rd</sup> Rapper                   |
| Teacher:                | - Mr Cainem                                |
| Running Bear:           | - 4 <sup>th</sup> Rapper                   |
| Sitting Bull            | - 5 <sup>th</sup> Rapper                   |
| Red Fox:                | - 6 <sup>th</sup> Rapper                   |
| Black Cloud:            | - 7 <sup>th</sup> Rapper                   |
| Charlie:                | - Customer in Saloon                       |
| Henry:                  | - Customer in Saloon                       |
| Flo:                    | - Customer in Saloon                       |

There can be many non-speaking roles in the saloon bar; playing cards, leaning on the bar, hanging around the piano etc.

Although Calamity Jane is based in the wild, wild West, the Rap-dancin' Tribe can be more a modern group of "Indians" who love to gather in a circle and play music, taking turns at Hip-Hop, Break Dance and Helicopter etc. This can involve more non-speaking roles drawing many more to attend the Play.

# **CALAMITY JANE**

## **THE PLAY**

### **ACT 1 Scene 1**

Saloon Bar in the old West. Customers are anxiously waiting for Calamity Jane to arrive from Chicago and ride shotgun on the stage. Song: "Achy Breaky Heart" for line dancing in the Saloon.

### **ACT 1 Scene 2**

Calamity and Rattlesnake arrive. Song: "Careless with the Truth"

### **ACT 1 Scene 3**

Calamity and the others leave the Saloon to board the stage coach.

### **ACT 2**

On the street outside the Saloon Bar. They board the stage coach and it starts to roll. Songs: "Windy City" and "Once I had a Secret Love".

### **ACT 3**

Somewhere on the edge of town. The school Rap-dancin' Troup is enjoying the "moves" and discussing how they can "test" a new teacher before he comes anywhere near the school. Lots of Rap music.

### **ACT 4**

The stage coach arrives with Calamity, safely in Chicago. New teacher boards and they head back to Dakota. Song: "Deadwood Stage".

### **ACT 5**

The Ambush. The Rap-dancin' Troup stop the stage coach to "test" the new school teacher. Song: "Black Hills of Dakota" plus Rap music. Teacher shows he can dance.

### **ACT 6**

Back in the Saloon Bar. All are waiting anxiously for the stage coach bringing the new school teacher. Song: Medley of songs from Calamity Jane plus Line Dancing and Rap.

# **CALAMITY JANE**

## **ACT 1 Scene 1**

A Saloon Bar in a pub in the old West. Choir can be extras on stage. Seated at tables are card playing cowboys and cowgirls. Cast includes Wild Bill Hickock, Army Lieutenant, Barman etc. As many as can fit on stage are Line Dancing and having fun as curtains open. Song and dancing ends and patrons whoop and cheer!

**BARMAN:** (Shouts) Hey, Wild Bill, when is Calamity gonna be here?

**HICKOCK:** Don't know, Shabby. I wish she would hurry up. We need her to ride shotgun (pointing) on the stage coach out there. It's about to leave.

**1<sup>st</sup> COWBOY:** Yep! We sure need some help to protect the stage coach. Every time it goes through Dakota Pass lately, that pesky Rap-dancin' Troup stop the coach and annoy the passengers with their dancing. And they are some of our students from the school!

**2<sup>nd</sup> COWBOY:** Last time we couldn't get away for about 2 hours. They throw a blanket on the ground, hold up the stage coach, force the passengers to stand around in a circle ... next thing they're doing helicopters and doing break dancin' ... the customers are not allowed to get back on the coach ...

**1<sup>st</sup> COWBOY:** ... and they put strings of beads around the passengers' necks ...

**2<sup>nd</sup> COWBOY:** And if you take the beads off, they make you rap dance.

**LIEUTENANT:** What?

**BARMAN:** Well, (holding up his beads) they ain't gettin' mine back ... I had to do hip hop for about 10 mins so I could keep these beads! (All laugh!)

**LIEUTENANT:** (Walking up to the cowboy's table) Look boys, let's hope Calamity gets here soon. I wish she was here now.

**BARMAN:** Maybe we shouldn't have fired the school teacher!

**LIEUTENANT:** Well, you caught him smoking in the classroom, didn't you.

**1<sup>st</sup> COWBOY:** Yeh! He was real stressed out! Them kids kept makin' him get down and dance ... in the playground ... like this! (Gets down and does some crazy rap-dancing)

**2<sup>nd</sup> COWBOY:** Well, Calamity will help us to bring the new school teacher into town. He's a lot stricter! He's from the Windy City, Chicago!

**HICKOCK:** Hey! That's where Calamity is from too. Everything Calamity talks about is BIG! Especially her stories, hey boys! (High-fives 2<sup>nd</sup> Cowboy)

**BARMAN:** Well I hope we can stop Calamity from tellin' her yarns ... just for 5 mins ... so we can tell her about the school teacher problem that we got.

**1<sup>st</sup> COWBOY:** She'll probably tell that story about how she rounded up 500 buffaloes in the hills ... all on her own ...

**2<sup>nd</sup> COWBOY:** ... and kraaled them in the Dakota Pass ... (All laugh!)

**HICKOCK:** If Calamity don't ride shotgun for us, the stage won't be able to get through in time for school on Monday ... (to audience) ... and it would be real sad if we couldn't have another new school teacher here by Monday ... wouldn't it! (Get reaction from audience. Song starts up again: "Achy Breaky Heart" ... all line up and dance. Curtains Half Close to allow focus on Calamity Jane and Rattlesnake dancing their way through audience to the stage ... Curtains Open fully as they enter stage and dance around with line dancers).



## **ACT 1 Scene 2**

(As song concludes, Calamity Jane and Rattlesnake move close to Lieutenant).

**LIEUTENANT:** Why, here's Calamity now!

**HICKOCK:** Hi Calam ... glad to see ya again!

**CALAMITY:** Howdy fellas! ... Ah hear you're having trouble again with them Rap-dancing boys ... from the Wild West Public School no less!.

**HICKOCK:** Sure am Calamity.

**CALAMITY:** (Standing up on a chair) Why, I'll stop them rascals. (Loudly) Did I tell you about the time I rounded up 500 buffaloes and drove them through Dakota Pass (Rattlesnake in the background indicates with fingers that it was only 2 buffaloes ... (all begin to laugh at Rattlesnake) ... (Calamity jumps down and faces Rattlesnake nose to nose) ... (Grabbing his lapels) How many buffalo was it ah! rounded up Rattlesnake?

**RATTLESNAKE:** (acting scared) As you said Calam, 500 ... 500 big ones too!

**CALAMITY:** That's better. Next time ah tells a story, keep your hands in your pockets, you toothless old buffalo. (All laugh)

**HICKOCK:** Now Calamity, the stage coach is ready to run ... and we wouldn't want you to be careless with the truth now ... would we!

**LIEUTENANT:** Yeh! We need to get the new school teacher through the Pass.

**CALAMITY:** Why you 'ornary old cowboys, careless with the truth am I. Wait 'til I get to them Rap-dancin' coyotes in my sights ... Let me tell you another story of mine ... (Music begins for "Careless With The Truth")

**ACT 1 Scene 3**

(As song "Careless with the Truth" fades)

**HICKOCK:** Enough of these shenanigans now, we've got a job to do!

**LIEUTENANT:** Yep! The Sheriff in Chicago city said he'd have our new school teacher waiting for the stage coach at the edge of town.

**1<sup>st</sup> COWBOY:** We was told he carries a cane about this long (holding arms outstretched).

**RATTLESNAKE:** Pity help them Rap-dancin' kids if they stop HIM at the Pass.

**2<sup>nd</sup> COWBOY:** Yeh! Calamity will frighten the hip hop out of them, and the new teacher will ... (Makes actions like he's caning Rattlesnake and others)

**CALAMITY:** (Interrupting) Where's the stage coach boys? Ah aim to teach them young fellas a lesson, once and for all. (All get ready to exit stage)

**LIEUTENANT:** Let's go men. Get Calamity on her way. (As the Curtains close)  
We must get the new school teacher here by Monday.

**CURTAINS**



## ACT 2

On the street outside the Saloon Bar.

Preparing the Stage Coach.

Scene acted around a makeshift stage coach.

Stage must have access to two seats up top for driver and two inside seats with passengers facing each other. Big "wagon wheels" can be turned by pupils hidden behind stage coach. Hay bales and barrels can add interest near the coach. Two "horses" (4 students) on stage tied up to a hitching rail. There can be other cowboys on "stage horses" comically prancing. Veranda behind the stage coach with locals hanging around, spinning six-guns, chewing straw. Some luggage on stage and some on veranda ready to be loaded.

Curtains open - enter Lieutenant, Calamity, Hickock and Rattlesnake

LIEUTENANT: Well Calamity, the stage coach is almost ready ... you can ride up top. (Step ladder behind stage coach to help them climb up on top seat and gathers reins - Hickock and Rattlesnake pick up luggage and load it onto top of stage coach – others can help).

CALAMITY: OK! Lieutenant. (Sidling up alongside him with her shotgun). But, maybe later on we can share the (leaning down pointing) back seat!

LIEUTENANT: Why Calam, you rascal, only if you sing me one of your purty (pretty) songs.

CALAMITY: Last time I sang me 'purty' song, I was in the old Opry House – you know they queued up for hours to hear me sing ...

RATTLESNAKE: ... the OPRY HOUSE? (Drops a suitcase off the stage coach onto his toe – jumps around holding his foot).

CALAMITY: (To Rattlesnake) It's about time you tied them horses to the stage coach you 'ornary old coot! (Rattlesnake and Hickock quickly unhitch the horses and attempt to bring them across the stage to the tune of "Alley Cat" – horses walk comically, crossed legs etc. into position. Hickock hands long reins up to Lieutenant and Calamity)

**RATTLESNAKE:** (Still holding horses by the halters ... laughing to audience ... when music and laughter fades ... loudly) ... Opry House! Oh! Yeh! I remember, the Karaoke Bar at The Star Hotel! (or local venue).

**CALAMITY:** Why you toothless old coyote ...

**LIEUTENANT:** (Interrupting) OK! Rattlesnake, let her roll!

**RATTLESNAKE:** (Rattlesnake stands back) Yeeha! Git up! You doggies!

**CALAMITY:** Now I feel like there's a song comin' on ... Git up! You brumbies! (Introduction to "Windy City" begins as Calamity stands holding the long reins.) Let her roll boys. (She stands on "moving" coach and sings to audience).

(The horses start galloping on the spot as the wagon wheels gradually turn. If possible, a video effect can be used to create a backdrop of a moving stage coach scene while Calamity and the Choir sing).

(If extra time needs to be added to the scene, Calamity can segue into "Once I had a secret love ... " ["My Secret Love"] This can be an ideal time to fade the song into INTERVAL if required.)

(Sample Scene below).



# **CALAMITY JANE**

## **ACT 3**



**Hip Hop in the Round. The Rap-dancin' Troup having a great time doing their dancing moves around a circle. Dress according to the cowboy culture etc.**

**Lights appropriate for dancing. Loud break-dance song playing. A La:**

**<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Df-zWhQhC50>**

**(This scene can be adjusted to suit the school standards and abilities. Eg. the Rap-dancin' Troup could be Line Dancin' Troup or appropriate to cultures.**

**Care should be taken NOT to cross discriminatory boundaries. The fun of this "Troup" is their dressing up in various cultural styles and rap-dancing to loud music with a rebellious attitude against that which Calamity Jane and the new school teacher potentially represent).**

**Chief, their leader is standing to one side. He is dressed more extravagantly than the others. He wears a long, feathered headdress. (The music and dancing fades to a stop when he raises his hand.)**

**CHIEF: (With hand raised holding a stick decorated with old CDs).**

**Friends, I have some news for you ... a new opportunity to clear our reputation. Just heard that Calamity Jane has gone back to Chicago to pick up the new school teacher. (Louder) The stage coach went through last night!**

**ALL: (They all gather) Oh! Yeh! Awesome! Etc. (Big noisy response)**

**CHIEF: The new school teacher must be very important ... they sent for Calamity Jane to bring him through here.**

**1<sup>st</sup> RAPPER: (To audience) We just love new school teachers, don't we! ... Ha! (Does some moves)**

**2<sup>nd</sup> RAPPER:** (With big boots and spurs) Let's see how good HIS moves are ... (does some moves – others, including girls, join in).

**CHIEF:** Now guys, remember, the idea is to test out our new school teacher. Let's see how HE responds to stress.

**3<sup>rd</sup> RAPPER:** We'll fall a tree ... to stop the stage in the narrow part of the Pass.

**1<sup>st</sup> RAPPER:** Now don't get me wrong, but that Calamity Jane is one liberated woman. And, she'll be riding shotgun on the stage when it gets here.

**4<sup>th</sup> RAPPER:** Well at least she doesn't CARRY that shotgun anymore.

**2<sup>nd</sup> RAPPER:** Well, there'll be people carrying money on that stage too, especially the new teacher. He probably got paid in advance ... he'll be carrying a big wallet, I'll bet.

**1<sup>st</sup> RAPPER:** Yeh! But, we're not after their money! We'll hit 'em with some of our new moves ... like this ... (dance move) ... to distract Calamity Jane and the Lieutenant ... they won't be able to resist ... look at this!!

**CHIEF:** Awesome man. Then we capture the Lieutenant and tie him up, the others will be too scared to move.

**1<sup>st</sup> RAPPER:** I will jump on the stage and grab Calamity, you hold the Lieutenant guy.

**CHIEF:** Then we'll make 'em all dance ... and give 'em some beads for their moves, Ha! Ha! (All laugh) ... but the new teacher is first on the floor, OK?

**3<sup>rd</sup> RAPPER:** OK! So let's go get a tree to block the track when they come through the Pass.

**2<sup>nd</sup> RAPPER:** I can't wait to see the new school teacher dance. He'll probably want to do a Waltz like my Grandma! (Music starts) I'll bet he can't do this! (They start another routine of Rap-dancing as the CURTAINS slowly close).

# **CALAMITY JANE**

## **ACT 4**

Curtains open to reveal stage coach rolling along – all singing “Deadwood Stage”. Wheels turn, horses gallop on the spot, Calamity Jane singing lead parts while “whipping” horses, holding reins. Song Ends as stage comes to a halt. A backdrop is added showing Chicago Coach Stop. Other cast members can be added to populate the Chicago street scene.

**LIEUTENANT:** (Sitting up next to Calamity) Well here we are Calamity. Let’s go meet the Sheriff of this here town, Chicago.

**CALAMITY:** OK! Lieutenant. Hold the reins while I dismount.

**SHERIFF:** (With teacher standing near) Howdy boys. I see you came through the Dakota Pass safe and sound this time.

**LIEUTENANT:** Yeh! Well that was because we had Calamity up front.

**CALAMITY:** Never caught sight of one rascal Rap-dancer in the Dakota Pass.

**RATTLESNAKE:** (With a big laugh) Or it might have been because of your singing Calam, Ha! Ha! Ha! (Calamity whips him around the backside. He runs off holding his buttocks – all laugh).

**SHERIFF:** I want you to meet your most important cargo, your new school teacher, Mr Will Cainem. (He walks around shaking hands).

**LIEUTENANT:** Howdy Will! Glad to meet ya! The children back at the State School are sure anxious to meet you.

**TEACHER:** Well that’s real fine Lieutenant. I’m looking forward to straightening out some issues that I’ve been hearing about.

(Rattlesnake re-enters scene tripping, ending up falling down near Teacher – looks up at Teacher, still on his knees)

TEACHER: (pulling a scane from under his belt) Now son, that's no way to dress. Tuck your shirt in and stand to attention.

RATTLESNAKE: But I don't go to school.

TEACHER: Don't back answer me son. Hold out your hand.

RATTLESNAKE: My Hand? (He holds it out, looking at it)

TEACHER: (Canes him on the hand) There, now do your shoe laces up and don't speak to me like that again. (Rattlesnake runs off shaking his hand trying to do up his shoe lace – all laugh!)

CALAMITY: Why, Mr Cainem, I like you! You sure live up to your name. What do you think Wild Bill?

HICKOCK: For sure, he'll rattle their cages, Calam. (Shakes teacher's hand).

SHERIFF: Well, we'd better get you through the Pass, and on your way to the school. Hop in the stage Mr Cainem. I'm sure Calamity and the boys will get you safely over the mountain Pass.



**HICKOCK:** (Picking up luggage) Wow! Heavy! What have you got in your luggage Mr Cainem?

**TEACHER:** Some presents for Calamity and the kids at the school ... if we make it back to town.

**LIEUTENANT:** I'm sure we'll make it OK Mr Cainem.

**HICKOCK:** (Drops Mr Cainem's luggage – it spills out on the street) Why! There's lots of sparkle in here. Beads that sparkle like a prism ...

**RATTLESNAKE:** (Looking in on Hickock putting the case back together ... holds up a bottle) Snake oil for yer! Rhumitism ...

**CALAMITY:** (Hopping up on the stage coach) Well, let's get goin' boys. We wouldn't want to disappoint the townsfolk back home.

**TEACHER:** (Boarding the coach) And we wouldn't want the children to miss out on school ... (to audience) ... would we everybody? (Threatening with his cane ... all shout Nooo!! Etc.)

**LIEUTENANT:** Got them horses strapped in Rattlesnake?

**RATTLESNAKE:** (Handing the reins up to Calamity) Yep! All ready to go.

**LIEUTENANT:** Let's go then.

(Music backing for song "Deadwood Stage" starts)

**CALAMITY:** (And all join in) "Whip crack away, whip crack away, whip crack away! Oh! The Deadwood stage is a ... " etc.

(The wheels start to turn as the horses begin to trot and canter again until curtains close)

**CURTAINS**

# CALAMITY JANE

## ACT 5



### The Ambush.

Curtains open to reveal the stage coach plodding along with Calamity singing "Black Hills Of Dakota". A few extra cowboys, cowgirls and "horses" accompany the stage. Calamity is up on top of stage with Rattlesnake. Teacher is in window view inside the stage.

Have a huge "tree" in a pot or roped so that it can fall across the "path" of the stage at the ambush. All are humming along with Calamity singing the lead. She finishes song, "To the beautiful Indian country that I love." Stage coach wheels still turning, horses moving on the spot.



**TEACHER:** (Leaning up, out window of stage) My word miss Calamity, you sure sing a purty song!

**CALAMITY:** Why thank you Mr Cainem.

Sure glad to see someone around here appreciates my singing. (Gives Rattlesnake a big elbow in the ribs.) Did I tell you about the time I rounded up 500 buffaloes on me own?

**TEACHER:** No. I don't believe you told me!

**CALAMITY:** Well I was riding through the Dakota Pass all on my own, not far from here and ...

**HICKOCK:** (Sitting in the coach with Mr Cainem) Hey, Calamity. Instead of telling that story AGAIN, why don't you show us some of your fancy sharp shooting!

**CALAMITY:** Well, OK boys! Hold them horse reins Lietenant. (Passes reins to Lieutenant - stands up and pulls six-gun from holster) ... you see that big pine tree over there (pointing off stage) with that scout sitting on the limb ... watch me shoot the limb right from under him ...

**ALL:** (Point and Shout) Ah! What? ... Who's that? ... Eeeeh! ... What's he doing?

(A tree suddenly falls across the stage – have sound effects if possible).

**LIEUTENANT:** (Stands and shouts) There's a tree across the road! (Pulls on reins. Wheels and horses all stop) Whoa! Whoa! there gee-gees!

(Hickock and Teacher stay put as Calamity and Lieutenant dismount from the top of the stage coach).

(Lots of noises by Rap-dancin' Troup off stage – then they suddenly run on and grab Calamity and Lieutenant, wrapping ropes around them. Other members grab cowboys off their horses and hold them by the arms).

**TEACHER:** What's going on? Quick let's get out!

**CHIEF:** (Running onto scene, pointing at Teacher) That's him, grab Hickock and new Teacher. (Some of gang grab Hickock as Teacher pulls his cane out of his belt and waves it around). Hold him! (They grab Teacher but can't reach his cane). He's new school Teacher all right.

**CALAMITY:** (To Chief) Yes, you feathered fowl house. Let him go or you will be real sorry.

**TEACHER:** Who are these rascals with feathers?

**CHIEF:** Me chief of the Rap-dancin' Troup and you are our captives. We from school where new teacher is headin'.

**TEACHER:** You mean you're students ... from the school?

**1<sup>st</sup> RAPPER:** We took charge of school because last teacher drank whiskey and smoked in the classroom.

**2<sup>nd</sup> RAPPER:** And we were getting the blame.

**CHIEF:** So we decided to take charge. (Chief kneels down and attempts to tie a big rope around Teacher's feet).

**TEACHER:** (Looking down) What are you doing son? Get off your knees. Stand up and hold out your hand.

**CHIEF:** My hand? (Holds out his hand while on his knees)

**TEACHER:** That's it. (Gives Chief a cane across his hand. Chief screams, jumps up and runs around holding and waving his hand. All laugh).

**CALAMITY:** Wow! Mr Cainem, I'm liking you more and more. You're just what the school needs all right.

**CHIEF:** (Coming back face to face Teacher) Right, now Teach, you dance ...

**TEACHER:** Don't you talk to me like that son. I'll have you kept in all lunch time tomorrow.

**1<sup>st</sup> RAPPER:** Well it's like this Mr Teacher. We don't do any detention 'till YOU pass the test!

**2<sup>nd</sup> RAPPER:** (Walking around) Don't know if you've noticed yet, but you're all tied up!

**TEACHER:** What test? What are you talking about?

**CALAMITY:** Let me loose, you young rascals.

**CHIEF:** Sorry ma'am, but we can't take the chance of getting blamed for doing nothing again.

**TEACHER:** Well, what's the test? I passed all of my degrees in Chicago.

**1<sup>st</sup> RAPPER:** (Scornfully) Yeh! But have you passed this one? ... music boys! (Chief puts a Ghetto Blaster down and when he presses the button loud Rap music starts playing. Rappers demo their moves to Mr Cainem).

**CHIEF:** (Pointing to Teacher) Untie him! (They begin to unwrap ropes) Now it's exam time, Teach ... you must dance to pass OUR test. (Music volume is controlled up and down by Rapper to allow audience to hear script).

**TEACHER:** (Taking off his cloak and mortar board) Is THAT all? Why, I come from the streets of Chicago ... let me see you do THIS!! (Teacher does an exciting dance on the floor etc. All start clapping and yahooping).

**RAPPERS:** Oh! Yeh! (Hi-fives, fist bumps etc.).

**CHIEF:** Let's join in! (The Rappers get in on the dance action).

**CALAMITY:** Rattlesnake, can you do that?

**RATTLESNAKE:** Sure I can. Let me go you rascals! (They untie him. Rattlesnake does some strange twisting dance. They all point and laugh).

**CHIEF:** (Turns music off). OK! OK! We're satisfied. (To Rap-dancin' Troup). Are we all happy to have Mr Cainem as our new school teacher, gang?

**RAPPERS:** (All Yeh! He's great! Shouts and Whoops). Let's help get him into town. (Calamity and others quickly get back into stage coach).

**CHIEF:** You (passes Ghetto Blaster up to Rattlesnake) can borrow my machine, man ... just press (points) the button ... (Rattlesnake presses the button and the song "Deadwood Stage" begins to play. Calamity begins to sing and everyone joins in. The stage coach begins to move again. The Rap-dance Troup join in dancing to the song as the curtains slowly close).

**CURTAINS**

# **CALAMITY JANE**

## **ACT 6**

### **Back In the Saloon Bar**

(Customers bored, waiting around for the Stage Coach to arrive. Some playing cards, others leaning on the Bar and tables, heads down. Barman cleaning glasses).

**CHARLIE:** (Lifting his head up off the table he's sleeping at) Hey! Henry, Henry Miller! We've been waiting here for days. When is Calamity Jane gonna get back with the new school teacher?

**HENRY:** Well she's always come through before. You just have another drink Charlie. Well wake you up when they arrive. (All laugh).

**BARMAN:** (Walking over to Charlie) Here Charlie, have a glass of milk, on the house! (Charlie holds the glass and falls back asleep, his head on the table).

**FLO:** (Standing up and pointing off-stage) Hey! Look. I think that's the stage coach coming now ... can you see it?

**CHARLIE:** (Waking up, holding up his glass of milk) Hip! Hip! Hooray! (Puts glass up to his mouth, takes a big drink then spits it all over the stage). (All laugh).

**FLO:** Yes, it's the stage. Yahooooooo! (All jump and cheers)

**BARMAN:** And the Rap-dance Troup are running along with the stage.

**HENRY:** Now that's different! Where's the new Chalkie?

**FLO:** He must be on the coach, if it came through the Pass, OK.

**CHARLIE:** Here they come. Let's give 'em a big cheer. (Loud Rap music starts. Charlie pulls his hat down over his head and blocks his ears. The Rap-dancin' Troup enters with teacher up on their shoulders. All including Calamity and others cheering and waving and dancing).

**LIEUTENANT:** (Music softens) Folks, let's give a huge welcome to our new school teacher Mr Will Cainem. (All cheer etc. as balloons drop from ceiling) And to a very brave, lovely lady, our sharp shootin' Calamity Jane! (All cheer etc.)

(Calamity and Teacher wave to crowd).

**CALAMITY:** Friends, what we have is a new teacher and a new opportunity. Your school has been suffering and we think we just delivered the panacea.

**CHARLIE:** (Intoxicated) I'll drink to that ... what's a panacea?

**TEACHER:** Have you been drinking son? You should know that word. Hold out your hand!

**CHARLIE:** But, I don't go to school. (Hold out his hand and gets the cane)

**CALAMITY:** (To audience) Told you to go to school Charlie! (Turns to crowd). Now let's have some dancin' boys. (Rap music starts. Troup and Teacher put on a Rap dance display. Then Rattlesnake runs out to front of stage, puts the Ghetto Blaster down and presses the button. All break into Line dancing as the Rap stops. After a few verses Calamity jumps up on a table and starts singing "Deadwood Stage" as line dancing music fades. All sing and dance to a choreographed finale as Calamity and Teacher wave to audience).

**CURTAINS – END OF PLAY**